IQly · A/B Test Plan

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November 6, 2026

Executive summary

The 3 bets: a visible per-question timer and an exit-intent sheet both target the quiz step (the funnel's largest leak for cold mobile traffic), and a "score free, report gated" gate redesign targets the highest-leverage single step before account creation.

Expected outcome: each test is sized to detect a 15% relative lift at 80% power; the two quiz-step tests share a step, so they run sequentially, while the gate test can run in parallel with either.

Priority order, ranked for CVR impact

#	Test	Step	Expected CVR impact	Why this rank
1	Test 3 — Score free, report gated	Gate	High	Every visitor who finishes the quiz hits the gate, so a gain here applies to 100% of the exposed audience, one step before the CVR numerator. Persona reviews showed hesitation concentrating at the email ask. Lowest regression risk: the percentile and the report stay gated.
2	Test 2 — Exit sheet	Quiz	Medium	Only acts on visitors who show leave intent, so its pool is smaller, but each recovered visitor is one who would otherwise convert at 0%. Cheap to build and almost no downside: it never blocks the flow.
3	Test 1 — Per-question timer	Quiz	Uncertain (could be negative)	It reaches everyone in the quiz but its direction is least certain: pace pressure can lift completion or raise anxiety for cold traffic. Run last, with the quiz-step guardrails watched closely.

Ranks are judgment calls from funnel position, exposed audience and downside risk, not measured effects: IQly has no traffic yet, so no impact numbers are claimed. The landing step is not tested because its main lever, ad-to-page message match, is already built into the control; there is no page_view → quiz_start data yet to show what to change.

Funnel diagram

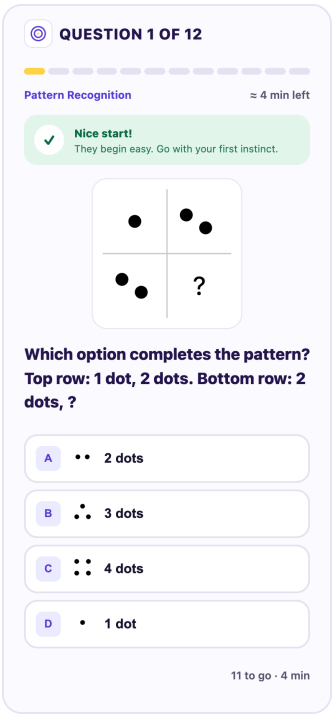


Complete → gate is a timed overlay with no tap required, so there's no decision point to A/B test. Post-signup steps drive engagement, not the brief's primary CVR metric, so they're out of scope for this round's 3 test slots.

QUIZ STEP

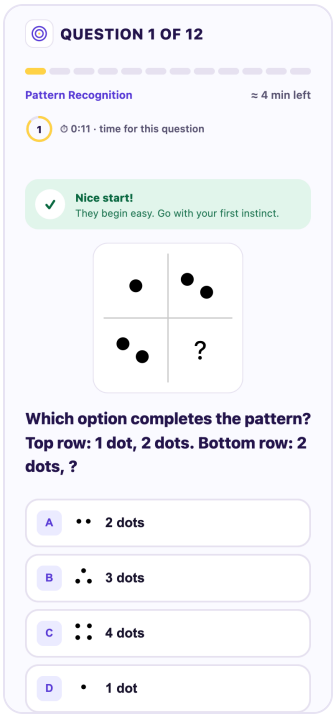
Test 1 — Visible per-question timer

`variant-1-question-timer.html · TIMER_MODE: per_question`



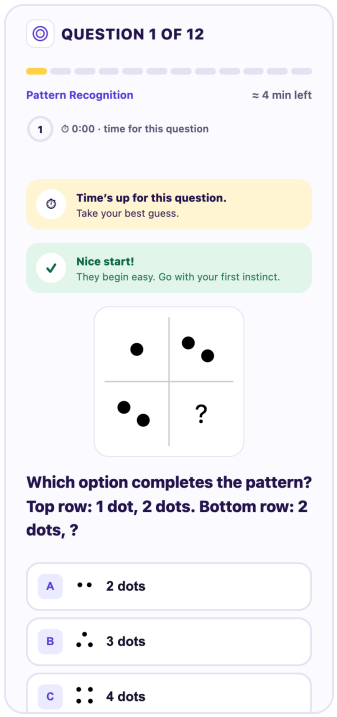
Control

No visible pacing cue beyond "≈4 min left"



Variant — ring + live label

Countdown ring around the question number, with "⏱ 0:11 · time for this question" — resets with a brief pulse on every new question



Variant — timer reaches zero

Ring drains and the last 5s switch to a contrast-checked warning color; "best guess" banner appears — no auto-advance, no wrong mark, question stays answerable

> A visible clock adds focus and signals test credibility ("this is a real test"), which raises engagement and the perceived value of the result, and so gate conversion. The main risk is the opposite: time pressure could stress mobile users into dropping off instead.

Primary	Overall CVR (account creations ÷ page visits)
Secondary	quiz_start → quiz_complete (does the timer help or hurt completion); gate_view → signup_success (does a more "credible-feeling" test convert better at the gate)
Diagnostic	Average time per question, drop-off by question index, `question_timeout` rate — shows whether the clock is adding pressure (high timeout rate) or barely registering (low rate)
Guardrail	Completion rate must not regress — a credibility win that costs completions is a net loss for a cold-traffic funnel

Sizing

Baseline quiz_start→quiz_complete 55% (placeholder) → 15% relative MDE: **557/arm (1,114 total)**, ~2 days at an assumed 1,000 visitors/day starting the quiz; runs a full 7-day cycle regardless.

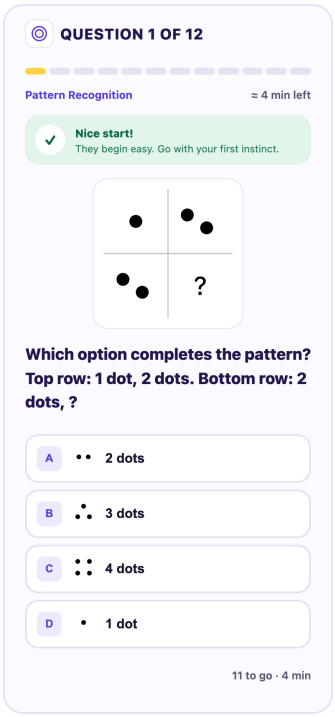
Key risks

Shares its funnel step with Test 2 — must run sequentially, not simultaneously, or an interaction effect would make either result unattributable. Time pressure is a double-edged mechanism for anxious, low-trust cold traffic.

QUIZ STEP

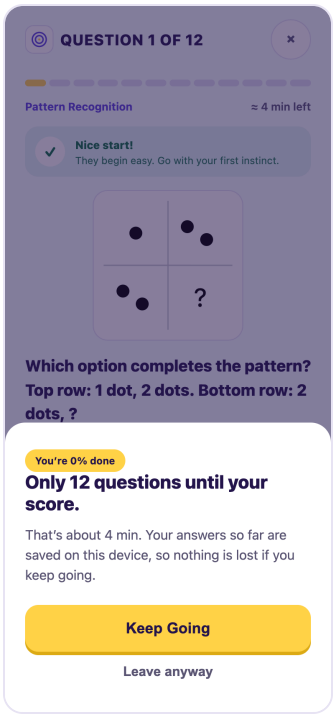
Test 2 — Exit-intent sheet

`variant-2-exit-sheet.html · EXIT_SHEET: on`



Control

No exit affordance during the quiz



Variant — exit sheet open

× button opens a sheet showing exact progress and a "Keep Going" recovery CTA

> Catching leave intent mid-quiz and showing the visitor exactly how close they are to their score recovers part of the mid-quiz drop-off — reframing "I'm about to quit" into "I'm almost done."

Primary	Overall CVR (account creations ÷ page visits)
Secondary	quiz_start → quiz_complete
Diagnostic	`exit_sheet_continue` ÷ `exit_sheet_open` — the recovery rate among visitors who showed leave intent, the clearest signal of whether the mechanism works at all
Guardrail	Time-to-complete — the sheet must genuinely re-engage people, not just stall them into converting out of friction

Sizing

Baseline quiz_start→quiz_complete 55% (placeholder) → 15% relative MDE: **557/arm (1,114 total)**, ~2 days at an assumed 1,000 visitors/day starting the quiz; runs a full 7-day cycle regardless.

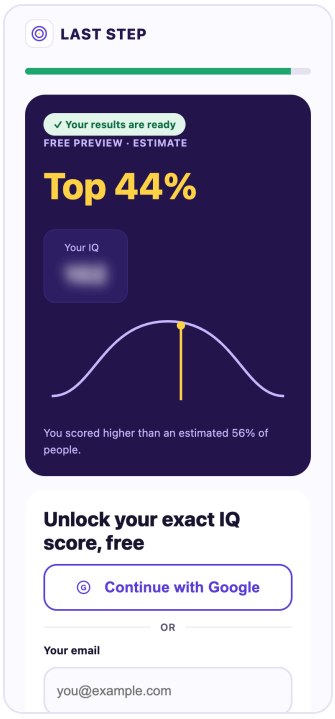
Key risks

Same funnel step and baseline as Test 1 — must run sequentially (or with a mutually exclusive split) against it, never simultaneously. A sheet that appears too eagerly on exit-intent gestures could itself feel like friction.

GATE STEP

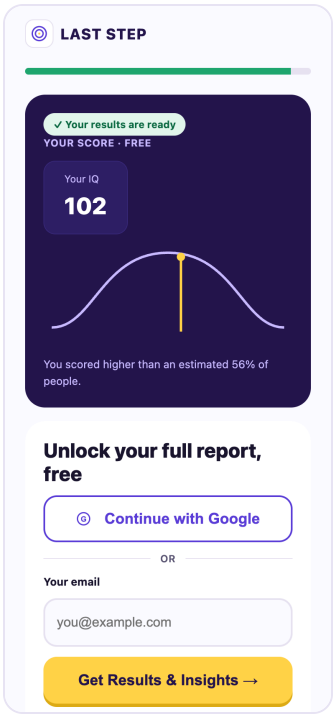
Test 3 — Score free, report gated

`variant-3-score-free-report-gated.html · GATE_MODE: score_free_report_gated`



Control — blurred exact IQ

Free: percentile band only. CTA: "Show My IQ Score →". Both arms now also offer "Continue with Google" and a blurred preview of the full report



Variant — unblurred exact IQ

Free: exact IQ (102) shown. CTA follows the gated value: "Get Results & Insights →". Preview card and checklist emphasize the insights, not the score

> For a zero-trust brand with no existing audience, giving the exact score away for free — gating only the skill profile and tips — builds enough trust and pride that visitors sign up to save the full report, outweighing the smaller curiosity gap left behind. (Google signup and the value-preview card ship in every arm — see the rollout note — so neither is part of this test's own change.)

Primary	Overall CVR (account creations ÷ page visits)
Secondary	gate_view → signup_success
Diagnostic	Google vs. email split among signups (tracked in every arm), to see whether the free score changes how people sign up
Guardrail	Share of signups that go on to open the full gated report — confirms giving away the exact score doesn't gut post-signup engagement with the rest of the report

Sizing

Baseline gate_view→signup_success 35% (placeholder) → 15% relative MDE: **1,336/arm (2,672 total)**, ~3 days at an assumed 1,000 visitors/day reaching the gate; runs a full 7-day cycle regardless.

Key risks

Targets a different, independent step from Tests 1/2 — can run in parallel with either. The main risk is the curiosity gap narrows enough that fewer visitors feel they need an account at all.

Rollout

1. **Order and split.** Run in rank order, Tests 1 and 2 sequentially (they share a step); user-level randomization, SRM check before trusting any result, results split by device.
2. **Decision rule.** Sample size and a minimum 7-day cycle are fixed before each test starts; no peeking, no early stop.
3. **Constant across arms.** "Continue with Google" (a labelled prototype) ships in control and every variant, so it is not a confound.

Sample sizes: `.claude/skills/ab-test-designer/scripts/power_calc.py` on placeholder step baselines. See `docs/ab-tests.md` for commands and the unspent backlog.